

VERITAS WORLDWIDE PRESS

VERITAS INSTITUTE

Field Manual

and Practical Course Library

A print-ready Veritas reference for urgent household, roadside, weather, utility, water, fire, and medical-continuity decisions, followed by source-backed course paths in skilled trades, repair, preparedness, food resilience, and healthcare-support work.

25 FIELD ANSWERS · 13 IMMEDIATE PROTOCOLS · 66 COURSE PATHS

22 HAZARD CATEGORIES · SOURCE-ANCHORED · PRINTABLE PDF

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Urgent answers first. Deeper skill paths second. Escalation gates always visible.

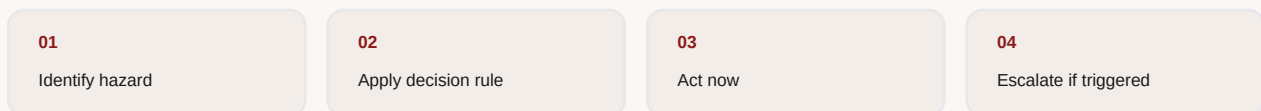
METHODOLOGY

The Veritas Institute field manual is built in two layers. Layer one handles the urgent question in front of the reader: bleeding, water, batteries, utilities, food safety, road trouble, fire, weather, power, evacuation, and household failure. Layer two turns recurring needs into structured courses covering the practical trades, repair, preparedness, food resilience, and healthcare-support work.

Every entry is written to avoid life-hack mythology. High-stakes work stays conservative. Official guidance, licensing bodies, extension systems, manufacturer instructions, and public safety resources outrank shortcuts, folklore, and influencer confidence.

STRESS-USE STRUCTURE

- Urgency tells the reader whether the first move is immediate, high-priority, or a planned reset.
- Time window states when the decision has to happen.
- Decision rule gives the non-negotiable logic before the checklist starts.
- Escalation gates make clear when the right answer is 911, the utility, the health department, a licensed trade, or a medical professional.

**PRIMARY SOURCE LADDER**

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Used to anchor practical trade, maintenance, logistics, and healthcare-support career paths in public labor data.

Ready.gov preparedness guidance: Used to structure household readiness, kits, outage planning, and emergency communications.

CDC emergency preparedness guidance: Used for water, hygiene, carbon monoxide, and first-response safety guardrails.

USDA and extension guidance: Used for food safety, preservation, gardening, and basic foraging discipline.

NHTSA vehicle safety guidance: Used for roadside safety, winter travel, battery recovery, and car-maintenance guardrails.

Energy.gov home energy guidance: Used for weatherization, backup-power planning, and household resilience systems.

National Archives research tools: Used for archival research discipline, record-group discovery, declassified-material paths, and historical source retrieval.

Congress.gov API: Used for legislative records, bill metadata, congressional actions, sponsors, committees, and official source paths.

Federal Register API documentation: Used for agency-rule discovery while preserving the requirement to verify legal precision against official editions.

FOIA.gov: Used for request preparation, agency identification, and the rule that public research should come before broad FOIA filing.

FEC campaign finance data: Used for federal campaign-finance lookup, committee records, receipts, spending, and filing discipline.

SEC EDGAR search filings: Used for company filings, securities disclosures, issuer search, and entity-name

verification.

USAspending API documentation: Used for federal award, recipient, agency, and spending-data workflows.

Data.gov: Used as a broad federal open-data catalog for research questions that do not begin in a single agency system.

CourtListener RECAP documentation: Used for court-record research context, RECAP coverage limits, and public PACER-document discovery paths.

National Weather Service safety guidance: Used for severe weather, flood, tornado, winter travel, heat, and alert-response guardrails.

Poison Help and America's Poison Centers: Used for poison-exposure escalation, plant-ingestion uncertainty, and the national Poison Help pathway.

American Red Cross first-aid guidance: Used for bleeding-control, first-aid escalation, hypothermia, and household emergency training boundaries.

NFPA home fire safety guidance: Used for home fire escape, smoke alarms, cooking fires, and household fire-prevention behaviors.

FDA food-safety emergency guidance: Used for power-outage food handling, refrigerator and freezer temperature thresholds, and flood-exposed food decisions.

EPA emergency drinking-water guidance: Used for drinking-water disinfection, boiling, filtering, and contaminated-water limits.

FIELD MANUAL ENTRIES

01. Dangerous berries vs edible berries — Foraging / High
02. Jump-start a car with limited supplies — Vehicle Recovery / High
03. Stop severe bleeding until help arrives — Emergency Medical / Immediate
04. Shut off a leaking house water line fast — Household Utilities / Immediate
05. Make emergency water safer to drink — Water / High
06. Respond to a gas smell inside the house — Household Utilities / Immediate
07. Know what food survives a power outage — Food Safety / Moderate
08. Heat and cook safely when the power is out — Outage Readiness / High
09. Control a roof leak before the repair crew arrives — Storm Damage / High
10. Keep sanitation under control during an outage — Household Health / High
11. Keep a phone alive and communications organized in an outage — Communications / Moderate
12. Get through a winter roadside stop without making it worse — Vehicle Readiness / Immediate
13. Run a generator without poisoning the house — Outage Power / Immediate
14. Stay alive around a downed power line — Electrical Hazard / Immediate
15. Get out of a house fire in under two minutes — Fire / Immediate
16. Stop a small pan fire without making it explode — Kitchen Fire / Immediate
17. Cool someone showing heat illness signs — Extreme Heat / Immediate
18. Handle hypothermia signs without shocking the person — Cold Exposure / Immediate
19. Shelter correctly during a tornado warning — Severe Weather / Immediate
20. Do not drive through floodwater — Flood / Immediate
21. Keep power-dependent medical devices alive during an outage — Medical Continuity / High
22. Handle wet electrical equipment after flooding or leaks — Electrical Cleanup / Immediate
23. Build a medication and documents grab bag — Evacuation / Moderate
24. Use a boil-water advisory without guessing — Water / High
25. Make smoke alarms a sleep-safety system — Fire / Moderate

PRACTICAL COURSE TRACKS

01. Skilled Trades and Field Careers — 10 courses
02. Healthcare and Care Careers — 10 courses
03. Home Repair, Vehicles, and Practical Maintenance — 10 courses
04. Food, Garden, and Self-Reliance — 10 courses
05. Preparedness, Medical Readiness, and Grid-Down Resilience — 10 courses
06. Communication, Learning, and Human Core Skills — 16 courses

FORAGING

Dangerous berries vs edible berries

This is a positive-identification problem, not a color trick. If you cannot identify the whole plant with certainty, you do not eat the berry.

HIGH · BEFORE ANYONE EATS; IMMEDIATELY IF SYMPTOMS BEGIN.

No whole-plant, region-specific positive identification means no eating.

When to use: You are foraging, hiking with children, or trying to confirm whether a wild berry is safe to eat.

QUICK ANSWER

Only eat a berry after a region-specific positive ID based on the whole plant, not one visual cue. Color alone is never enough.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Photograph the whole plant: leaves, stem, berry cluster, and growth habit.
- Use a local field guide or extension resource that matches your exact region and season.
- If anyone has already eaten the berry and symptoms begin, keep a sample and call Poison Control immediately.

AVOID

- Do not trust bird activity, folklore, or one-app image guesses as proof of safety.
- Do not taste-test an unknown berry “just to see.”
- Do not let children forage unsupervised around ornamental shrubs or woodland edges.

GEAR

- Phone camera
- Regional field guide
- Poison Control contact

ESCALATE IF

- A child, older adult, or pet ate an unknown plant.
- Vomiting, trouble breathing, seizure, collapse, confusion, or severe pain appears.
- You cannot identify the plant with certainty after ingestion.

SOURCE ANCHORS

State extension office, Poison Control, Regional plant identification guide

VEHICLE RECOVERY

Jump-start a car with limited supplies

The safe workaround is a rated jump pack, booster, or power station with proper vehicle-start leads. Random household wire is not a workaround. It is a fire risk.

HIGH · BEFORE THE FIRST CABLE CONNECTION.

Only use equipment rated for vehicle starting and the vehicle battery system in front of you.

When to use: Your battery is dead, you are away from a shop, and you have limited but legitimate starting equipment.

QUICK ANSWER

Use jumper cables, a battery booster, or a power station built for vehicle starting. Do not improvise with extension cords, speaker wire, or bare household copper.

01

Recognize

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Control hazard

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Use source anchor

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Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Confirm the vehicle uses a standard 12-volt system and that the battery case is not cracked or leaking.
- Connect positive to the dead battery first, then to the live source; connect negative to a clean engine or chassis ground.
- Start the helper source, start the dead vehicle, then remove the leads in reverse order.

AVOID

- Do not connect improvised household wire to battery posts.
- Do not smoke or lean over the battery while making connections.
- Do not keep cranking if the battery is swollen, hissing, or the cables are heating up.

GEAR

- Rated jumper cables or jump pack
- Eye protection
- Owner manual

ESCALATE IF

- The battery is cracked, leaking, swollen, frozen, hissing, or hot.
- Cables heat, spark aggressively, smoke, or cannot clamp securely.
- The vehicle is hybrid, electric, or has manufacturer jump-start steps you cannot verify.

SOURCE ANCHORS

NHTSA roadside guidance, Owner manual, Jump-pack or booster manual

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Maintain a car yourself — How to Maintain a Car Yourself

EMERGENCY MEDICAL

Stop severe bleeding until help arrives

Heavy bleeding is a minutes problem. Pressure, packing, and tourniquet decisions need to happen fast and cleanly.

IMMEDIATE · FIRST 0-5 MINUTES.

Call 911, put firm pressure on the source, and use wound packing or a tourniquet only as trained and anatomically appropriate.

When to use: A person is bleeding heavily, blood is pooling or spurting, or clothing is soaking through quickly.

QUICK ANSWER

Call emergency services, apply firm direct pressure immediately, pack deep wounds if trained and equipped, and use a tourniquet for life-threatening limb bleeding when pressure is not enough.

01

Recognize

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Control hazard

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Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Call 911 or direct someone specific to call while you start pressure.
- Use gloved hands or the cleanest cloth available and press hard without lifting every few seconds to check.
- If a limb wound will not stop, apply a tourniquet high and tight and note the time.

AVOID

- Do not remove a well-placed dressing just to look unless you must repack the wound.
- Do not use a makeshift neck tourniquet or wrap around the chest or abdomen.
- Do not treat this guide as a replacement for Stop the Bleed or certified first-aid training.

GEAR

- Gloves or hand barrier
- Gauze or clean cloth
- Commercial tourniquet

ESCALATE IF

- Blood spurts, pools, or soaks clothing or dressings quickly.
- The person becomes pale, confused, cold, dizzy, or less responsive.
- The scene is unsafe, the wound is deep, or an object is embedded.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Stop the Bleed, American Red Cross, EMS dispatcher instructions

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Stop bleeding and handle trauma until help arrives — Bleeding Control and Trauma Readiness

HOUSEHOLD UTILITIES

Shut off a leaking house water line fast

Small leaks become structural damage fast. The first skill is knowing where the main shutoff is and how it turns before you need it under pressure.

IMMEDIATE · FIRST 2-10 MINUTES.

Stop flow first, relieve pressure second, document damage third.

When to use: A pipe bursts, a fixture line fails, a toilet supply starts spraying, or water is spreading across floors or walls.

QUICK ANSWER

Shut off the nearest fixture valve first if it works. If it does not, shut off the house main immediately and open a low faucet to relieve pressure.

01

Recognize

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Control hazard

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Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Find the fixture shutoff and try that first; if it fails, go straight to the main.
- Turn the valve fully in the correct direction and verify the water flow drops at a nearby faucet.
- Photograph the failure, mop or extract standing water, and begin drying immediately.

AVOID

- Do not waste time searching for tools after the floor is already flooding.
- Do not assume the main valve works if you have never tested it before.
- Do not reopen the line until the failed fitting, hose, or pipe has been replaced or isolated.

GEAR

- Flashlight
- Valve key or adjustable wrench
- Towels, mop, or wet vacuum

ESCALATE IF

- Water reaches electrical devices, outlets, panels, ceilings, or insulation.
- The main valve does not stop flow.
- Structural materials stay wet or sewage is involved.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Local water utility, Homeowner utility map, Licensed plumber emergency checklist

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Replace a faucet — How to Replace a Faucet

WATER

Make emergency water safer to drink

Filtration, boiling, and chemical treatment solve different problems. The first job is understanding which contamination risk you are dealing with.

HIGH · BEFORE DRINKING, COOKING, BRUSHING TEETH, WASHING FOOD, OR MAKING ICE.

Germs can often be handled with boiling or approved treatment; fuel, chemicals, and radioactive material require another water source.

When to use: Storm outages, broken municipal service, boil notices, travel, or any case where your normal drinking water is not trustworthy.

QUICK ANSWER

Start with the cleanest source you have, pre-filter sediment, then use the right treatment method for the actual risk. No single tool handles every contamination scenario.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Use stored tap water first if you have it; otherwise collect the clearest source available.
- Filter visible sediment through clean cloth first so the treatment method can work better.
- Boil for biological risk, use approved treatment chemicals as directed, and know when chemical contamination requires a different source entirely.

AVOID

- Do not assume a simple camp filter removes fuel, industrial chemicals, or every dissolved contaminant.
- Do not treat cloudy water once and call it safe without pre-filtering.
- Do not store treated water in dirty containers.

GEAR

- Clean containers
- Pot or kettle
- Filter cloth, EPA/CDC treatment method, or bottled water

ESCALATE IF

- Water smells like fuel, chemicals, sewage, or has an unusual color or oily sheen.
- A local health department gives instructions that differ from generic guidance.
- Infants, immunocompromised people, or medical equipment depend on the water.

SOURCE ANCHORS

CDC water guidance, EPA drinking water resources, Ready.gov

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Purify water in an emergency — How to Purify Water in an Emergency

HOUSEHOLD UTILITIES

Respond to a gas smell inside the house

Natural gas and propane are evacuate-first problems. The right first move is distance and reporting, not indoor troubleshooting.

IMMEDIATE · AT THE FIRST SMELL, HISS, ALARM, OR SUSPECTED LEAK.

Evacuate before troubleshooting; calls happen from outside the structure.

When to use: You smell gas, hear a hiss near a gas line, or suspect an appliance leak.

QUICK ANSWER

Do not switch lights, do not use devices, and do not hunt for the leak indoors. Get everyone out, move away from the structure, and call the gas utility or 911 from outside.

01

Recognize

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Control hazard

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Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Evacuate immediately and warn everyone else on the way out.
- Leave doors open only if you can do it without delaying evacuation.
- Call the utility emergency line or fire department once you are at a safe distance.

AVOID

- Do not turn switches on or off.
- Do not start a car in an attached garage or near the leak zone.
- Do not re-enter until the utility or fire department says it is safe.

GEAR

- Utility emergency number
- Outdoor phone
- Household meeting point

ESCALATE IF

- Anyone feels dizzy, nauseated, weak, or short of breath.
- You hear a hiss, see damaged gas equipment, or smell gas indoors.
- An ignition source, fire, explosion, or blocked exit is present.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Gas utility emergency line, Local fire department, Appliance safety manual

FOOD SAFETY

Know what food survives a power outage

The mistake people make is trusting cold food after the clock has already run too long. Temperature and time matter more than optimism.

MODERATE · FIRST 4 REFRIGERATOR HOURS; FREEZER CHECK WHEN POWER RETURNS.

Temperature records beat smell, taste, appearance, and hope.

When to use: A refrigerator or freezer has lost power, you are cleaning out coolers, or you are deciding what to keep after an outage.

QUICK ANSWER

Keep refrigerator food only if it stayed below 40°F and freezer food only if it still has ice crystals or stayed solid. When in doubt, throw it out.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Keep doors closed as much as possible to preserve cold air.
- Use a food thermometer if you have one and write down which items crossed the safe temperature line.
- Prioritize shelf-stable food and preserved water until cold storage is trustworthy again.

AVOID

- Do not taste food to decide whether it is safe.
- Do not refreeze thawed food that has clearly warmed into the danger zone.
- Do not overpack a weak cooler without enough ice or cold packs.

GEAR

- Appliance thermometer
- Cooler
- Ice or frozen gel packs

ESCALATE IF

- Perishable food has been above 40°F for two hours or more.
- Floodwater touched food, containers, utensils, or food-contact surfaces.
- Someone in the household is pregnant, immunocompromised, elderly, or very young.

SOURCE ANCHORS

USDA FSIS, FDA food safety guidance, Ready.gov

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Build long-term food storage — How to Build Long-Term Food Storage

OUTAGE READINESS

Heat and cook safely when the power is out

The dangerous shortcut is treating any flame source as an indoor solution. Fuel, ventilation, and carbon monoxide discipline come first.

HIGH · BEFORE LIGHTING, PLUGGING IN, OR REFUELING ANY BACKUP HEAT OR COOKING DEVICE.

Outdoor combustion stays outdoors; indoor-rated combustion still needs ventilation, clearance, and working carbon monoxide alarms.

When to use: Extended outage, winter storm, or any event where your normal heating and cooking systems are down.

QUICK ANSWER

Use only the heating or cooking devices rated for the space you are using. Outdoor stoves stay outdoors, and every indoor combustion source requires ventilation and carbon monoxide awareness.

01

Recognize

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Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Check what you already own and sort it into indoor-safe, outdoor-only, and not-safe-for-this-use.
- Set a carbon monoxide alarm or fresh battery before you rely on any combustion heat source.
- Plan one simple meal method and one warm-room strategy instead of trying to heat the whole house at once.

AVOID

- Do not run grills, camp stoves, or generators inside a house, garage, or enclosed porch.
- Do not sleep with unsafe heating sources running.
- Do not improvise fuel storage next to flame or heater surfaces.

GEAR

- Carbon monoxide alarm
- Manufacturer manual
- Outdoor-rated cord or approved indoor fuel only

ESCALATE IF

- A carbon monoxide alarm sounds or anyone develops headache, dizziness, weakness, nausea, or confusion.
- The only available heat source is outdoor-only.
- Fuel storage, cords, or ventilation cannot be made safe.

SOURCE ANCHORS

CDC carbon monoxide guidance, Ready.gov, Manufacturer safety manuals

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Heat and cook when the grid is down — Heat and Cook When the Grid Is Down

STORM DAMAGE

Control a roof leak before the repair crew arrives

A temporary tarp and water control plan buy you time. The real win is limiting interior damage until weather and labor allow a proper repair.

HIGH · INTERIOR CONTROL NOW; EXTERIOR TARP ONLY DURING A SAFE WEATHER WINDOW.

Interior damage control beats unsafe roof access.

When to use: Rain is entering through the roof, shingles are missing, or you need a temporary exterior control measure after storm damage.

QUICK ANSWER

Map the interior leak first, protect belongings, then tarp from a safe ladder position only if weather and height conditions are controlled. If not, stay inside and limit damage.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Catch water, move furniture, and relieve any ceiling bulge safely if it is filling with water.
- Photograph the damage for insurance and repair documentation.
- Tarp only if you have dry enough conditions, the right ladder setup, and a second person spotting.

AVOID

- Do not climb onto a wet, steep, or storm-active roof.
- Do not assume the visible drip is directly below the exterior failure point.
- Do not skip drying the interior while waiting for the exterior repair.

GEAR

- Buckets and plastic sheeting
- Camera
- Tarp, rope, and ladder only if conditions are safe

ESCALATE IF

- Water is near electrical devices, recessed lights, wiring, or the service panel.
- Ceiling material sags, cracks, or smells musty.
- Wind, lightning, roof pitch, ice, or ladder setup makes exterior access unsafe.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Roofing manufacturer guidance, Local building department, Weather service advisory

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Repair a roof leak — How to Diagnose and Repair a Roof Leak

HOUSEHOLD HEALTH

Keep sanitation under control during an outage

Outages become health problems when water, toilet, and handwashing systems fail at the same time. Sanitation needs a plan before people get tired and start improvising badly.

HIGH · BEFORE THE FIRST OVERFLOW, BACKUP, OR MIXED-USE WATER CONTAINER.

Separate clean water, gray water, and waste immediately.

When to use: Running water is down, sewer function is uncertain, or the household is sheltering in place for more than a few hours.

QUICK ANSWER

Plan toilet use, handwashing, and waste containment together. If the water system is compromised, separate clean water, gray water, and waste immediately.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Assign one toilet or backup sanitation method and make the household use it consistently.
- Set up a handwashing station with clean water, soap, and towels or sanitizer.
- Bag, label, and isolate waste materials so they do not migrate through the living area.

AVOID

- Do not let contaminated cleanup cloths mix with drinking-water containers or food surfaces.
- Do not wait until the first overflow or backup to decide the plan.
- Do not assume bleach solves every sanitation problem without correct dilution and clean-water separation.

GEAR

- Soap or sanitizer
- Heavy bags and labels
- Disinfectant matched to label directions

ESCALATE IF

- Sewage backs up into living areas.
- Waste contacts food, drinking-water containers, or medical supplies.
- A child, elderly person, or immunocompromised person may have been exposed.

SOURCE ANCHORS

CDC sanitation guidance, Local health department, Ready.gov

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Handle sanitation during an outage — How to Handle Sanitation During an Outage

COMMUNICATIONS

Keep a phone alive and communications organized in an outage

The simplest communications plan is usually the best one: low-power settings, agreed check-in windows, and one backup charging layer.

MODERATE · AT OUTAGE START, BEFORE THE PHONE FALLS BELOW 50 PERCENT.

Preserve battery for alerts, text, navigation, and emergency calls before comfort use.

When to use: Power is unstable, the cell network is congested, or you need to stretch battery life through an outage or evacuation.

QUICK ANSWER

Put the phone in low-power mode early, reduce screen use, preserve battery for messages and navigation, and centralize charging around one reliable backup source.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Lower brightness, disable nonessential radios, and close power-hungry apps immediately.
- Text instead of calling when the network is overloaded.
- Set a household contact plan so everyone is not draining batteries with constant check-ins.

AVOID

- Do not burn battery on entertainment, video, or constant app refreshing.
- Do not wait until 5 percent battery to find a charging plan.
- Do not assume cell data will stay stable even if signal bars look normal.

GEAR

- Charged power bank
- Vehicle charger
- Written contact plan

ESCALATE IF

- Emergency alerts, evacuation orders, or medical check-ins depend on the device.
- A family member is separated and there is no agreed check-in window.
- Cell service is failing and you have a NOAA/weather radio or local broadcast option available.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Ready.gov communications guidance, FEMA family plan resources, Backup battery manual

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Use ham radio in an emergency — How to Use Ham Radio in an Emergency

VEHICLE READINESS

Get through a winter roadside stop without making it worse

In cold weather, the first goal is staying visible, warm, and conservatively powered until you can move or help arrives.

IMMEDIATE · FIRST 10 MINUTES, THEN HOURLY UNTIL HELP OR SAFE MOVEMENT.

Stay with the vehicle unless shelter is plainly visible and close; manage carbon monoxide and visibility first.

When to use: You are stranded, spun out, or forced to stop in freezing conditions.

QUICK ANSWER

Stay with the vehicle unless remaining there is clearly more dangerous, preserve engine fuel carefully, keep the exhaust path clear, and use layers and signaling before panic-driven movement.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Clear snow from the tailpipe before running the engine for heat.
- Use hazard lights, reflective gear, or flares if conditions allow.
- Run the engine in short cycles, keep a window cracked, and preserve fuel for the long wait.

AVOID

- Do not walk away in whiteout or low-visibility conditions unless you know exactly where warm shelter is.
- Do not let the exhaust pipe stay buried under drifting snow.
- Do not spin tires endlessly and burn traction or battery without a plan.

GEAR

- Winter vehicle kit
- Reflective marker or hazard lights
- Blankets and water

ESCALATE IF

- Exhaust cannot stay clear, fuel is critically low, or carbon monoxide symptoms appear.
- A person is wet, shivering uncontrollably, confused, or unusually drowsy.
- The vehicle is in an active traffic lane or another immediate hazard zone.

SOURCE ANCHORS

NHTSA winter driving guidance, State DOT winter advisory, Owner manual

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Build a 72-hour emergency kit — How to Build a 72-Hour Emergency Kit

OUTAGE POWER

Run a generator without poisoning the house

Portable generators solve one problem and create another if exhaust drifts into the home. Carbon monoxide has no useful warning smell.

IMMEDIATE · BEFORE STARTUP AND AFTER EVERY PLACEMENT CHANGE.

Fuel-burning backup power stays outdoors, at least 20 feet from doors, windows, vents, and attached garages.

When to use: You are using or considering a generator, fuel-powered tool, grill, camp stove, or backup power source during an outage.

QUICK ANSWER

Place the generator outside with exhaust pointed away from the structure, use outdoor-rated cords, keep it dry, and run working carbon monoxide alarms inside.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

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Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Measure or pace the generator away from doors, windows, vents, and attached garages before starting it.
- Point exhaust away from the house and any neighboring openings.
- Use heavy-duty outdoor-rated cords and plug only the loads you have intentionally prioritized.

AVOID

- Do not run a generator in a garage, carport, basement, porch, shed, or near an open window.
- Do not backfeed a house panel without a transfer switch installed by a qualified electrician.
- Do not refuel a hot running generator.

GEAR

- Carbon monoxide alarms
- Outdoor-rated extension cords
- Generator manual and fuel plan

ESCALATE IF

- A carbon monoxide alarm sounds or anyone has headache, dizziness, weakness, nausea, confusion, or chest pain.
- Weather, theft risk, or cord length prevents safe outdoor placement.
- You need to power medical equipment and cannot maintain safe generator operation.

SOURCE ANCHORS

CDC carbon monoxide guidance, Ready.gov power outage guidance, Generator manual

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Install solar backup power at home — Understand Solar Backup Power at Home

ELECTRICAL HAZARD

Stay alive around a downed power line

A downed line can energize the ground around it. The danger is not just touching the wire; it is stepping through voltage difference.

IMMEDIATE · UNTIL THE UTILITY CONFIRMS THE LINE IS DE-ENERGIZED.

Stay far away, keep others back, and let the utility or fire department control the scene.

When to use: A storm, crash, falling tree, or damaged pole leaves wires on the ground, on a vehicle, or near standing water.

QUICK ANSWER

Assume every downed line is live. Stay back, avoid water and fences near it, call 911 or the utility, and shuffle away with feet together if you must move from an energized area.

01

Recognize

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Control hazard

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Use source anchor

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Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Call 911 or the utility emergency line and give the exact location.
- Warn people to stay back from wires, puddles, fences, trees, and vehicles touching the line.
- If you must move away, keep feet close together and shuffle without taking large steps.

AVOID

- Do not touch the line with a tool, branch, vehicle, ladder, or rope.
- Do not drive over a downed line.
- Do not approach a person or vehicle touching the line until responders say it is safe.

GEAR

- Phone
- Flashlight or cones for distance marking
- Utility emergency number

ESCALATE IF

- A line is on a vehicle with people inside.
- Fire, smoke, arcing, water, gas smell, or structural damage is present.
- Bystanders cannot be kept away from the hazard zone.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Local electric utility, National Weather Service storm safety, Fire department instructions

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Do basic home electrical troubleshooting safely — Basic Home Electrical Troubleshooting Safely

FIRE

Get out of a house fire in under two minutes

Fire escape is a movement problem, not a belongings problem. The household needs two exits, a meeting point, and a rule against going back inside.

IMMEDIATE · UNDER TWO MINUTES ONCE THE ALARM OR FIRE CONDITION BEGINS.

Get people out first, then call 911 from the meeting point.

When to use: A smoke alarm sounds, smoke appears, a room is burning, or you are planning the household fire drill before an emergency.

QUICK ANSWER

Move low under smoke, use the nearest safe exit, avoid hot doors, meet outside at the chosen spot, call 911, and do not re-enter.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Move toward the safest exit while staying low if smoke is present.
- Check doors for heat before opening and use a second exit if the door or handle is hot.
- Meet at the planned outdoor spot and tell firefighters who may still be inside.

AVOID

- Do not search for valuables, pets, documents, or the source of the fire before leaving.
- Do not open a hot or smoke-leaking door.
- Do not go back inside once you are out.

GEAR

- Working smoke alarms
- Escape ladder for upper floors if needed
- Written meeting point

ESCALATE IF

- A person cannot self-evacuate.
- Smoke blocks the exits.
- Burns, smoke inhalation, trapped occupants, or missing people are involved.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Ready.gov home fire escape plan, NFPA home fire safety, Local fire department

KITCHEN FIRE

Stop a small pan fire without making it explode

Grease fires punish panic. Water spreads burning oil; oxygen control and evacuation discipline matter more.

IMMEDIATE · FIRST SECONDS, ONLY WHILE THE FIRE IS SMALL AND ESCAPE IS CLEAR.

If it is small and contained, smother it; if not, evacuate and call 911.

When to use: Oil, grease, or food ignites in a pan, oven, or cooktop area.

QUICK ANSWER

Turn off heat if safe, slide a lid over a small pan fire, leave it covered, use a proper extinguisher only if trained, and evacuate if the fire grows.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Turn off the burner if you can do it without reaching through flame.
- Slide a lid or baking sheet over the pan and leave it covered until completely cool.
- Evacuate and call 911 if the fire spreads, smoke thickens, or you are unsure.

AVOID

- Do not pour water on a grease fire.
- Do not carry a burning pan through the house.
- Do not uncover the pan early to check.

GEAR

- Fitted lid or baking sheet
- Class B/K-rated extinguisher if trained
- Clear exit path

ESCALATE IF

- Flames leave the pan, reach cabinets, or enter the range hood.
- Smoke makes breathing or visibility difficult.
- The extinguisher is not the right class or you have no clear exit behind you.

SOURCE ANCHORS

NFPA cooking safety, Local fire department, Extinguisher label

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Bake bread with basic pantry supplies — How to Bake Bread With Basic Pantry Supplies

EXTREME HEAT

Cool someone showing heat illness signs

Heat illness moves from uncomfortable to life-threatening when confusion, collapse, or inability to cool appears.

IMMEDIATE · FIRST 0-10 MINUTES AFTER SYMPTOMS ARE RECOGNIZED.

Move, cool, hydrate if awake, and escalate fast for confusion, collapse, or worsening symptoms.

When to use: Someone in hot weather is sweating heavily, nauseated, faint, confused, cramping, or no longer acting normally.

QUICK ANSWER

Move the person to a cool place, remove excess layers, cool skin with wet cloths or water, give sips of water if awake, and call emergency services for severe or worsening signs.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Move the person out of heat and stop exertion immediately.
- Cool the body with wet cloths, water, fans, shade, or air conditioning.
- Offer small sips of water only if the person is awake and able to swallow safely.

AVOID

- Do not keep them working or walking to prove toughness.
- Do not give alcohol or force fluids into a confused or unconscious person.
- Do not wait for a thermometer before acting on severe symptoms.

GEAR

- Water
- Shade or air conditioning
- Cool wet cloths or spray bottle

ESCALATE IF

- Confusion, fainting, seizure, loss of consciousness, or very hot skin appears.
- Symptoms get worse after cooling begins.
- The person is elderly, very young, pregnant, medically fragile, or taking heat-risk medications.

SOURCE ANCHORS

CDC heat illness guidance, National Weather Service heat safety, Local emergency medical instructions

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Stay safe in extreme weather — How to Stay Safe in Extreme Weather

COLD EXPOSURE

Handle hypothermia signs without shocking the person

Cold exposure becomes dangerous when the person cannot think or move well. Rough handling and wrong warming sequence can make severe cases worse.

IMMEDIATE · FIRST 0-10 MINUTES AFTER RECOGNITION.

Shelter, dry, warm the core, and get medical help for confusion, temperature below 95°F, or severe symptoms.

When to use: A person is cold, wet, confused, exhausted, slurring speech, fumbling, unusually drowsy, or has stopped shivering.

QUICK ANSWER

Move the person gently to shelter, remove wet clothing, warm the chest, neck, head, and groin, avoid alcohol, and get medical help quickly.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Move the person out of wind, water, and cold ground.
- Remove wet clothing and wrap them in dry layers including head and neck.
- Warm the core first with blankets, body heat, or safe heat sources.

AVOID

- Do not rub limbs, use alcohol, or warm hands and feet first in severe cold exposure.
- Do not put an unconscious or confused person in a hot bath.
- Do not give drinks to someone who cannot swallow safely.

GEAR

- Dry layers or blankets
- Warm sweet drink only if awake
- Thermometer if available

ESCALATE IF

- The person is confused, drowsy, has slurred speech, or has a temperature below 95°F.
- They are unconscious, not breathing normally, or have no obvious pulse.
- Cold exposure follows water immersion, injury, intoxication, or prolonged outdoor exposure.

SOURCE ANCHORS

CDC hypothermia guidance, National Weather Service winter safety, American Red Cross winter storm guidance

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Stay safe in extreme weather — How to Stay Safe in Extreme Weather

SEVERE WEATHER

Shelter correctly during a tornado warning

The safest available place is low, interior, and away from glass. The wrong move is staying in a vehicle, mobile home, or windowed room too long.

IMMEDIATE · IMMEDIATELY WHEN WARNING ARRIVES; DO NOT WAIT FOR VISUAL CONFIRMATION.

Lowest level, smallest interior space, protect the head, stay away from windows.

When to use: A tornado warning is issued, sirens sound, a tornado is visible, or severe rotating storm conditions approach.

QUICK ANSWER

Go to a basement or small interior room on the lowest floor, cover your head and body, keep shoes on, and stay there until warnings clear.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Move to the lowest available interior room, hallway, closet, or bathroom.
- Put walls between you and the outside and cover your head and neck.
- Bring shoes, phone, and critical medications if they are already nearby.

AVOID

- Do not shelter near windows, exterior doors, or large-span rooms.
- Do not stay in a mobile home if a stronger shelter is reachable in time.
- Do not try to photograph or watch the tornado from outside.

GEAR

- Shoes
- Weather radio or alerts
- Helmet, pillow, mattress, or heavy blanket

ESCALATE IF

- You are in a vehicle, mobile home, temporary structure, or large public building.
- A person has mobility limitations and needs immediate help moving to shelter.
- Debris impact, structural damage, gas smell, or injuries occur after the storm.

SOURCE ANCHORS

National Weather Service tornado safety, Ready.gov tornado guidance, Local emergency alerts

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Stay safe in extreme weather — How to Stay Safe in Extreme Weather

FLOOD

Do not drive through floodwater

Flood depth is not visible from the driver seat, and the road may be gone underneath. Turning around is the action, not the slogan.

IMMEDIATE · BEFORE THE VEHICLE ENTERS WATER.

Unknown water on a roadway means stop, turn around, and choose a different route.

When to use: Water covers a road, bridge, underpass, low crossing, driveway, or evacuation route.

QUICK ANSWER

Never drive into floodwater. Turn around, move to higher ground when needed, obey barricades, and abandon the vehicle only if rising water makes staying more dangerous and escape is safe.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Stop before the water and turn around without testing depth.
- Use official road closures, weather alerts, and local emergency instructions.
- If water rises around a stopped vehicle, leave for higher ground only when it is safe to do so.

AVOID

- Do not drive around barricades.
- Do not assume a familiar road is intact under water.
- Do not let darkness, urgency, or vehicle size persuade you to cross.

GEAR

- Weather alerts
- Alternate route
- Phone and emergency contact plan

ESCALATE IF

- Water is rising around you or moving fast.
- Someone is trapped in a vehicle or swept into water.
- Evacuation routes are closing and official instructions are changing.

SOURCE ANCHORS

National Weather Service flood safety, Ready.gov flood guidance, State DOT road closures

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Stay safe in extreme weather — How to Stay Safe in Extreme Weather

MEDICAL CONTINUITY

Keep power-dependent medical devices alive during an outage

Medical power planning is not the same as convenience charging. The plan needs device priority, backup runtime, provider guidance, and a relocation threshold.

HIGH · BEFORE OUTAGE SEASON AND AGAIN AT THE FIRST OUTAGE ALERT.

Know the runtime, backup source, and evacuation threshold before batteries are low.

When to use: A household depends on oxygen, CPAP/BiPAP, refrigerated medication, powered mobility, dialysis support, hearing aids, or other medical equipment.

QUICK ANSWER

List each device, its power draw, backup runtime, charging method, and medical fallback; contact the provider or utility early when the backup window is shorter than the outage risk.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Write down each device, battery runtime, charger type, and required storage temperature.
- Charge backups early and protect refrigerated medication with thermometer-confirmed cold storage.
- Call the medical provider, utility medical needs program, or local emergency management before the backup window collapses.

AVOID

- Do not assume a consumer power bank can run medical equipment safely.
- Do not wait until the backup battery is nearly dead before relocating.
- Do not run fuel-powered backup power indoors or near openings.

GEAR

- Device manual
- Backup battery or generator plan
- Provider and utility contact list

ESCALATE IF

- Backup power will run out before utility restoration is likely.
- Medication temperature cannot be maintained.
- The person has breathing, mobility, dialysis, or life-support needs that cannot tolerate interruption.

SOURCE ANCHORS

CDC power sources guidance, Ready.gov power outage guidance, Device manufacturer instructions

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Build a 72-hour emergency kit — How to Build a 72-Hour Emergency Kit

ELECTRICAL CLEANUP

Handle wet electrical equipment after flooding or leaks

Water and electricity turn cleanup into an electrocution problem. The first decision is whether you can safely stay away and call the right help.

IMMEDIATE · BEFORE TOUCHING WATER, BREAKERS, CORDS, OR APPLIANCES.

If you are wet, standing in water, or near energized equipment, stay out and call for help.

When to use: Water contacts outlets, cords, appliances, a breaker panel, extension cords, or electrical equipment after a leak, flood, or storm.

QUICK ANSWER

Do not enter standing water near electrical equipment. If safe from a dry location, shut power off at the main; otherwise call the utility, fire department, or electrician.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Keep people away from wet electrical areas.
- Shut off power only from a dry, safe location that does not require stepping into water.
- Have wet outlets, panels, cords, and appliances inspected before reuse.

AVOID

- Do not touch breakers, plugs, cords, appliances, or water if you are wet or standing in water.
- Do not reuse flooded electrical equipment just because it turns on.
- Do not run extension cords through wet areas.

GEAR

- Phone
- Flashlight
- Licensed electrician or utility contact

ESCALATE IF

- A breaker panel, outlet, appliance, or service entrance is wet.
- You smell burning, see arcing, hear buzzing, or lights flicker after water exposure.
- Floodwater, sewage, or storm damage is involved.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Local electric utility, CDC disaster cleanup guidance, Licensed electrician

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Do basic home electrical troubleshooting safely — Basic Home Electrical Troubleshooting Safely

EVACUATION

Build a medication and documents grab bag

Evacuations fail in small details: prescriptions, IDs, insurance cards, chargers, and medical instructions scattered across the house.

MODERATE · BEFORE AN EVACUATION ORDER; REFRESH MONTHLY.

The bag should let the household leave in minutes without losing medical continuity or identity documents.

When to use: Storms, fires, evacuations, hospital trips, travel disruption, or any household that depends on daily medication or medical records.

QUICK ANSWER

Keep copies of IDs, insurance cards, medication lists, allergies, provider contacts, chargers, and a rotation plan for essential medicines in one reachable bag.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Photograph and copy IDs, insurance cards, prescriptions, and critical documents.
- Write one medication list with dose, schedule, prescribing provider, pharmacy, and allergy notes.
- Use a monthly calendar reminder to rotate anything that expires or changes.

AVOID

- Do not store the only copy of critical documents in the bag.
- Do not let medication lists drift after prescription changes.
- Do not bury the bag where it cannot be reached quickly.

GEAR

- Waterproof document pouch
- Medication list
- Chargers and backup battery

ESCALATE IF

- A medication requires refrigeration, injection supplies, oxygen, or powered equipment.
- A person cannot explain their own medical needs during stress.
- Evacuation may separate caregivers from dependents.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Ready.gov emergency kit guidance, CDC power sources guidance, Provider medication instructions

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Build a 72-hour emergency kit — How to Build a 72-Hour Emergency Kit

WATER

Use a boil-water advisory without guessing

A boil-water advisory changes ordinary tasks: drinking, brushing teeth, baby formula, ice, dishwashing, and food prep all need the same rule set.

HIGH · IMMEDIATELY AFTER ADVISORY, UNTIL THE ALL-CLEAR IS ISSUED.

Use bottled, boiled, or properly treated water for anything that can enter the body.

When to use: A utility, health department, school, campground, or local authority issues a boil-water notice or says water may be unsafe.

QUICK ANSWER

Use bottled water if available. Otherwise bring clear water to a rolling boil for 1 minute, or 3 minutes above 6,500 feet, then cool and store in clean containers.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Use safe water for drinking, cooking, brushing teeth, washing food, baby formula, handwashing when required, and making ice.
- Filter cloudy water through clean cloth before boiling or treating.
- Follow local health department instructions for start time, affected area, and all-clear.

AVOID

- Do not use unsafe tap water for ice, baby formula, brushing teeth, or rinsing ready-to-eat food.
- Do not assume a filter pitcher replaces boiling or official treatment guidance.
- Do not store boiled water in dirty containers.

GEAR

- Clean pot
- Clean covered containers
- Bottled water or approved treatment method

ESCALATE IF

- Water may contain fuel, chemicals, sewage, or flood contamination.
- An infant, immunocompromised person, or medical device depends on the water.
- You cannot boil, treat, or obtain safe water before the household needs it.

SOURCE ANCHORS

CDC emergency water guidance, EPA emergency disinfection guidance, Local health department

COMPANION COURSE PATH

Purify water in an emergency — How to Purify Water in an Emergency

FIRE

Make smoke alarms a sleep-safety system

Smoke alarms are not decor. They are the system that wakes people up when sight and smell are late.

MODERATE · BEFORE SLEEP AND DURING MONTHLY HOUSEHOLD RESET.

Every sleeping area needs a working alarm path that can wake the people inside.

When to use: You are setting up a home, rental, short-term stay, child-care routine, or seasonal safety reset.

QUICK ANSWER

Put working smoke alarms on every level and inside or near sleeping areas, test them on schedule, and pair them with a practiced escape route and meeting point.

01

Recognize

02

Control hazard

03

Use source anchor

04

Escalate if triggered

DO NOW

- Test each alarm and replace batteries or units according to label instructions.
- Confirm alarms are present where people sleep and that everyone recognizes the sound.
- Walk two ways out of each room and confirm the outside meeting point.

AVOID

- Do not remove batteries for nuisance alarms without fixing the cause.
- Do not assume one alarm in a hallway protects every room.
- Do not delay escape-plan practice until after a fire.

GEAR

- Smoke alarms
- Fresh batteries if required
- Escape plan and meeting point

ESCALATE IF

- A person cannot wake to the alarm or needs assistance evacuating.
- The building has locked, blocked, painted-shut, or barred exits.
- You cannot install, replace, or test alarms yourself.

SOURCE ANCHORS

Ready.gov home fire escape plan, NFPA smoke alarm guidance, Local fire department

QUICK REFERENCE BY CATEGORY

Foraging

Dangerous berries vs edible berries: High. No whole-plant, region-specific positive identification means no eating.

Vehicle Recovery

Jump-start a car with limited supplies: High. Only use equipment rated for vehicle starting and the vehicle battery system in front of you.

Emergency Medical

Stop severe bleeding until help arrives: Immediate. Call 911, put firm pressure on the source, and use wound packing or a tourniquet only as trained and anatomically appropriate.

Household Utilities

Shut off a leaking house water line fast: Immediate. Stop flow first, relieve pressure second, document damage third.

Respond to a gas smell inside the house: Immediate. Evacuate before troubleshooting; calls happen from outside the structure.

Water

Make emergency water safer to drink: High. Germs can often be handled with boiling or approved treatment; fuel, chemicals, and radioactive material require another water source.

Use a boil-water advisory without guessing: High. Use bottled, boiled, or properly treated water for anything that can enter the body.

Food Safety

Know what food survives a power outage: Moderate. Temperature records beat smell, taste, appearance, and hope.

Outage Readiness

Heat and cook safely when the power is out: High. Outdoor combustion stays outdoors; indoor-rated combustion still needs ventilation, clearance, and working carbon monoxide alarms.

Storm Damage

Control a roof leak before the repair crew arrives: High. Interior damage control beats unsafe roof access.

Household Health

Keep sanitation under control during an outage: High. Separate clean water, gray water, and waste immediately.

Communications

Keep a phone alive and communications organized in an outage: Moderate. Preserve battery for alerts, text, navigation, and emergency calls before comfort use.

Vehicle Readiness

Get through a winter roadside stop without making it worse: Immediate. Stay with the vehicle unless shelter is plainly visible and close; manage carbon monoxide and visibility first.

Outage Power

Run a generator without poisoning the house: Immediate. Fuel-burning backup power stays outdoors, at least 20 feet from doors, windows, vents, and attached garages.

Electrical Hazard

Stay alive around a downed power line: Immediate. Stay far away, keep others back, and let the utility or fire department control the scene.

Fire

Get out of a house fire in under two minutes: Immediate. Get people out first, then call 911 from the meeting point.

Make smoke alarms a sleep-safety system: Moderate. Every sleeping area needs a working alarm path that can wake the people inside.

Kitchen Fire

Stop a small pan fire without making it explode: Immediate. If it is small and contained, smother it; if not, evacuate and call 911.

Extreme Heat

Cool someone showing heat illness signs: Immediate. Move, cool, hydrate if awake, and escalate fast for confusion, collapse, or worsening symptoms.

Cold Exposure

Handle hypothermia signs without shocking the person: Immediate. Shelter, dry, warm the core, and get medical help for confusion, temperature below 95°F, or severe symptoms.

Severe Weather

Shelter correctly during a tornado warning: Immediate. Lowest level, smallest interior space, protect the head, stay away from windows.

Flood

Do not drive through floodwater: Immediate. Unknown water on a roadway means stop, turn around, and choose a different route.

Medical Continuity

Keep power-dependent medical devices alive during an outage: High. Know the runtime, backup source, and evacuation threshold before batteries are low.

Electrical Cleanup

Handle wet electrical equipment after flooding or leaks: Immediate. If you are wet, standing in water, or near energized equipment, stay out and call for help.

Evacuation

Build a medication and documents grab bag: Moderate. The bag should let the household leave in minutes without losing medical continuity or identity documents.

TRADES

Skilled Trades and Field Careers

Hands-on careers remain one of the fastest ways to convert training into income without a four-year reset.

Demand signal: Built from current U.S. labor-market demand and occupation pathways surfaced by the Bureau of Labor Statistics and apprenticeship systems.

Method note: Licensing, safety, and code constraints outrank speed. The institute never treats hazardous work as casual DIY.

Become a welder

Follow a source-backed path into welding through safety training, process basics, test pieces, and employer-recognized credentials.

First action: Map the local paths: community college, union apprenticeship, employer shop training, or an AWS-aligned program.

Guide answer: To become a welder, make the first move explicit: Map the local paths: community college, union apprenticeship, employer shop training, or an AWS-aligned program. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and American Welding Society to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Welding is not casual maker content. PPE, ventilation, fire safety, and supervisor feedback are non-negotiable.

Become an electrician

Build an electrician pathway through code literacy, math basics, apprenticeship structure, and supervised field hours.

First action: Identify the licensing path in your state and compare union, non-union, and contractor-sponsored apprenticeships.

Guide answer: To become an electrician, make the first move explicit: Identify the licensing path in your state and compare union, non-union, and contractor-sponsored apprenticeships. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and state licensing board to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Live electrical work is lethal. Training starts with theory, safety, and supervised field practice, not home experimentation.

Become an HVAC technician

Move into HVAC through refrigeration basics, troubleshooting habits, safety training, and credentialed entry paths.

First action: Compare short HVAC programs, employer-sponsored training, and apprenticeship-style field entry in your local market.

Guide answer: To become an HVAC technician, make the first move explicit: Compare short HVAC programs, employer-sponsored training, and apprenticeship-style field entry in your local market. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and EPA Section 608 guidance to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Refrigerants, electricity, ladders, and combustion systems create real risk. Training and supervision matter.

Become a plumber

Enter plumbing through apprenticeship structure, code fundamentals, pipe systems literacy, and safe service habits.

First action: Find the state licensing ladder and list the contractors, unions, and trade schools that feed it locally.

Guide answer: To become a plumber, make the first move explicit: Find the state licensing ladder and list the contractors, unions, and trade schools that feed it locally. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and state licensing board to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Plumbing intersects sanitation, gas, code, and property damage. Unsupervised field shortcuts become expensive fast.

Become a CDL truck driver

Understand CDL classes, ELDT requirements, endorsements, safety records, and the first employer choices that shape income.

First action: Choose the license class and route type you actually want before paying for training.

Guide answer: To become a CDL truck driver, make the first move explicit: Choose the license class and route type you actually want before paying for training. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use FMCSA and state DMV to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Do not choose a carrier based on headline pay alone. Training debt, schedule, and safety culture matter more.

Become an auto mechanic

Start in automotive repair by learning inspection logic, diagnostics basics, tool progression, and the economics of shop work.

First action: Pick a path: dealership, independent shop, fleet maintenance, or specialty repair.

Guide answer: To become an auto mechanic, make the first move explicit: Pick a path: dealership, independent shop, fleet maintenance, or specialty repair. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and ASE to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Tool debt can bury beginners. Buy in stages and let the job prove what earns a permanent spot in the box.

Become a wind turbine technician

Build a path into wind tech work by understanding the physical demands, safety systems, travel realities, and technical prerequisites.

First action: Confirm whether you want utility-scale travel work or a local maintenance role before choosing training.

Guide answer: To become a wind turbine technician, make the first move explicit: Confirm whether you want utility-scale travel work or a local maintenance role before choosing training. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and technical colleges to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This is a height, rescue, and weather-exposed job. The lifestyle and safety demands are part of the career, not side notes.

Become a solar installer

Understand rooftop and ground-mount work, electrical coordination, fall protection, and the local installer market.

First action: Map whether local demand is residential retrofit, commercial install, or maintenance and inspection.

Guide answer: To become a solar installer, make the first move explicit: Map whether local demand is residential retrofit, commercial install, or maintenance and inspection. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and OSHA training providers to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Roofing, electricity, weather, and lifting risks make safety systems central to the job.

Become a heavy equipment operator

Learn how to move toward civil, site, and infrastructure work through training, safety records, and operator readiness.

First action: List the operators, unions, and training schools in your region and study what machine families they hire for first.

Guide answer: To become a heavy equipment operator, make the first move explicit: List the operators, unions, and training schools in your region and study what machine families they hire for first. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and state apprenticeship office to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Machine operation is a safety system, not a thrill. Ground crews, sight lines, and site protocol matter as much as control skill.

Become a lineman

Understand the apprenticeship pipeline, physical demands, storm work realities, and high-consequence safety culture of line work.

First action: Research union utility apprenticeships and the prerequisites they expect before you apply.

Guide answer: To become a lineman, make the first move explicit: Research union utility apprenticeships and the prerequisites they expect before you apply. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and utility apprenticeship programs to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Line work is high-risk industrial labor. If you do not respect the safety culture, this is not the path for you.

HEALTHCARE

Healthcare and Care Careers

Healthcare-adjacent roles keep ranking high because they offer clear training pathways and durable demand.

Demand signal: Structured around public healthcare workforce demand, credential pathways, and stackable role transitions.

Method note: Clinical instruction is introductory only. High-stakes care always points back to accredited programs and supervised practice.

Become a CNA

Build a clean route into nursing support work through approved training, exam prep, and employer fit.

First action: Find the state-approved CNA programs, testing vendors, and hiring facilities in your region.

Guide answer: To become a CNA, make the first move explicit: Find the state-approved CNA programs, testing vendors, and hiring facilities in your region. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use state nurse aide registry and community college health programs to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Healthcare support work is emotionally and physically demanding. Choose clinical settings with serious onboarding and supervision.

Become a phlebotomist

Move into phlebotomy by understanding training requirements, clinical hours, patient interaction, and certification choices.

First action: Confirm whether your state or employers expect a national certification before choosing a training program.

Guide answer: To become a phlebotomist, make the first move explicit: Confirm whether your state or employers expect a national certification before choosing a training program. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use community college health programs and national certification bodies to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Clinical precision and patient communication matter more than speed. You are working on real people, not reps.

Become a medical assistant

Prepare for a blended clinical and administrative role by understanding employer expectations, program quality, and skill stacking.

First action: Choose whether you want a faster certificate route or a broader program with stronger externship support.

Guide answer: To become a medical assistant, make the first move explicit: Choose whether you want a faster certificate route or a broader program with stronger externship support. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics and community college health programs to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Do not confuse speed with quality. Externship placement and employer recognition matter.

Become an LPN

Understand what LPN programs demand, how licensure works, and how the role differs across settings.

First action: List the approved programs in your state and compare cost, NCLEX-PN outcomes, schedule, and support.

Guide answer: To become an LPN, make the first move explicit: List the approved programs in your state and compare cost, NCLEX-PN outcomes, schedule, and support. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use state board of nursing and U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This is clinical education, not a shortcut. Your program quality and exam readiness matter more than branding.

Become an EMT

Move toward emergency medical work with a realistic view of training, certification, stress tolerance, and field conditions.

First action: Validate your schedule, stress tolerance, and local training options before enrolling.

Guide answer: To become an EMT, make the first move explicit: Validate your schedule, stress tolerance, and local training options before enrolling. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use NREMT and state EMS office to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This work has real trauma exposure. Emotional durability and supervised training matter as much as passing the

exam.

Become a sterile processing technician

Enter a behind-the-scenes healthcare role by mastering process discipline, instrument handling, and employer-recognized credentials.

First action: Research whether local employers train on the job or strongly prefer certification upfront.

Guide answer: To become a sterile processing technician, make the first move explicit: Research whether local employers train on the job or strongly prefer certification upfront. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use HSPA and hospital career pages to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Precision matters. Instrument handling, documentation, and sterile workflow are not low-consequence tasks.

Become a pharmacy technician

Learn how to enter pharmacy support work through state rule mapping, certification planning, and workplace fit.

First action: Check the state board requirements first. Some states require registration, some expect certification, and employers vary.

Guide answer: To become a pharmacy technician, make the first move explicit: Check the state board requirements first. Some states require registration, some expect certification, and employers vary. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use state board of pharmacy and PTCB to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Accuracy and patient safety matter. Do not treat medication workflows as low-risk clerical work.

Become a dental assistant

Understand the mix of chairside support, sterilization, patient flow, and state-specific requirements that shape this role.

First action: Check state-specific radiography and credential rules before choosing a program.

Guide answer: To become a dental assistant, make the first move explicit: Check state-specific radiography and credential rules before choosing a program. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use state dental board and DANB to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Do not assume every state treats this role the same. Local credential rules matter.

Become a caregiver or home health aide

Build a path into care work with attention to training, scheduling, documentation, and emotional durability.

First action: Decide whether you want agency work, private-pay work, or a route that ladders into certified care roles.

Guide answer: To become a caregiver or home health aide, make the first move explicit: Decide whether you want agency work, private-pay work, or a route that ladders into certified care roles. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use state health department and Medicare home health guidance to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Care work without boundaries burns people out. Training, documentation, and employer quality matter.

Become a behavioral health technician

Understand the training, de-escalation skills, environment fit, and supervision needs behind behavioral health support work.

First action: Learn the settings first: inpatient, residential, crisis, youth, substance-use, or community support.

Guide answer: To become a behavioral health technician, make the first move explicit: Learn the settings first: inpatient, residential, crisis, youth, substance-use, or community support. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Map the Role | Training and Safety | Proof of Work

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: Show labs, supervised practice, certifications in progress, or shadowing evidence an employer can scan quickly. | Verified floor: Use state behavioral health agencies and hospital career pages to verify entry requirements, safety rules, and role expectations. | Leverage signal: Progress means getting closer to paid supervised work, not collecting disconnected credentials.

Action sequence: Choose the correct entry lane -> Learn the safety and baseline theory -> Build proof, not just notes

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This work requires boundaries, de-escalation, and strong supervision. Hero narratives are a bad fit here.

REPAIR

Home Repair, Vehicles, and Practical Maintenance

Repair literacy is a cost-of-living skill. People search it because every ignored failure compounds.

Demand signal: Grounded in constant consumer demand for maintenance, repair, and household cost control.

Method note: Safety and code boundaries stay explicit. Readers are told when a licensed trade or inspection is the right move.

Fix drywall

Handle the most common drywall repairs with cleaner prep, better finishing sequence, and less sanding chaos.

First action: Identify the damage type first: nail hole, dent, seam issue, water damage, or cutout patch.

Guide answer: To fix drywall, make the first move explicit: Identify the damage type first: nail hole, dent, seam issue, water damage, or cutout patch. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. | Verified floor: Use public home repair guidance and manufacturer installation guides to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: If there is active moisture, movement, or possible structural damage, stop and diagnose that first.

Tile a bathroom floor

Get better results by treating substrate prep and layout as the real work instead of rushing to the visible part.

First action: Check subfloor condition, movement, and height transitions before choosing tile or mortar.

Guide answer: To tile a bathroom floor, make the first move explicit: Check subfloor condition, movement, and height transitions before choosing tile or mortar. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. | Verified floor: Use manufacturer installation guides and building code resources to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Waterproofing and floor prep matter more than the tile pattern. Skip them and the job fails later.

Replace a faucet

Replace a common faucet with better prep, fewer stripped fittings, and less under-sink frustration.

First action: Confirm the shutoff valves work before you buy parts or disconnect anything.

Guide answer: To replace a faucet, make the first move explicit: Confirm the shutoff valves work before you buy parts or disconnect anything. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. |
Verified floor: Use manufacturer installation guides and public plumbing guidance to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: If the shutoffs fail or the connections are corroded, the project scope just changed.

Install a water heater

Understand the process, code boundaries, and hazard points before deciding whether this is a DIY job or licensed work.

First action: Confirm the heater type, venting, local code rules, and permit requirements before touching the old unit.

Guide answer: To install a water heater, make the first move explicit: Confirm the heater type, venting, local code rules, and permit requirements before touching the old unit. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. |
Verified floor: Use local building department and manufacturer installation guides to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Gas, venting, pressure relief, leaks, and code compliance make this a frequent "call a pro" threshold.

Repair a roof leak

Find the true leak path, control interior damage, and avoid the common mistake of patching the wrong spot.

First action: Document where the water appears indoors, then trace the likely path upslope before climbing outside.

Guide answer: To repair a roof leak, make the first move explicit: Document where the water appears indoors, then trace the likely path upslope before climbing outside. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. |
Verified floor: Use public home repair guidance and manufacturer roofing guides to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Height, weather, and hidden water paths make roof work riskier than it looks.

Do basic home electrical troubleshooting safely

Learn how to inspect symptoms, isolate circuits, and know when to stop before a minor issue becomes a dangerous one.

First action: Start with symptoms, breaker map, and outlet behavior before opening boxes or replacing devices.

Guide answer: To do basic home electrical troubleshooting safely, make the first move explicit: Start with symptoms, breaker map, and outlet behavior before opening boxes or replacing devices. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. |
Verified floor: Use local electrical code guidance and manufacturer device guides to confirm safety and code boundaries before

acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This guide is about diagnosis and thresholds, not unlicensed electrical work.

Maintain a car yourself

Handle the recurring maintenance tasks that prevent bigger failures and teach you how the vehicle is aging.

First action: Read the manual and create a maintenance schedule based on the actual vehicle, mileage, and driving conditions.

Guide answer: To maintain a car yourself, make the first move explicit: Read the manual and create a maintenance schedule based on the actual vehicle, mileage, and driving conditions. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. |

Verified floor: Use manufacturer owner manuals and NHTSA to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Maintenance is great until safety-critical work exceeds your tools, workspace, or confidence.

Change your own brakes safely

Learn the workflow, inspection points, and safety habits that separate a real brake job from a cosmetic parts swap.

First action: Confirm you have the exact parts, safe jacking setup, torque specs, and enough time to do the job without rushing.

Guide answer: To change your own brakes safely, make the first move explicit: Confirm you have the exact parts, safe jacking setup, torque specs, and enough time to do the job without rushing. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. |

Verified floor: Use manufacturer service information and NHTSA to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: If you cannot verify torque, rotor condition, fluid status, and test-drive behavior, stop and get qualified help.

Buy a used car without getting burned

Use a disciplined inspection and negotiation process so urgency does not push you into someone else's deferred maintenance.

First action: Set your walk-away rules before you shop: budget, total cost, must-have documents, and inspection standards.

Guide answer: To buy a used car without getting burned, make the first move explicit: Set your walk-away rules before you shop: budget, total cost, must-have documents, and inspection standards. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. |

Verified floor: Use NHTSA and consumer auto buying guidance to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: If the seller resists records or an inspection, that is information, not an inconvenience.

Winterize a home

Protect a home against cold weather with a prioritized sequence that starts with damage prevention and heat retention.

First action: Walk the house and rank the weak points: exposed pipes, drafts, roof issues, heat systems, and exterior drainage.

Guide answer: To winterize a home, make the first move explicit: Walk the house and rank the weak points: exposed pipes, drafts, roof issues, heat systems, and exterior drainage. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Diagnose Before Acting | Plan the Job | Do the Repair

Proof standard: Proof of repair: Diagnosis notes, the correct material list, and a visible test procedure prove the repair is real. |

Verified floor: Use Energy.gov home energy guidance and public weatherization guidance to confirm safety and code boundaries before acting. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer repeat failures and clearer escalation decisions.

Action sequence: Diagnose the actual problem -> Stage the workspace and tools -> Work in the safest sequence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Do not ignore combustion safety, venting, or failing heating equipment in the name of DIY thrift.

FOOD & GARDEN

Food, Garden, and Self-Reliance

The most durable resilience skills are the ones that reduce dependence before a crisis begins.

Demand signal: Built from ongoing search demand for gardening, food storage, preservation, backyard food systems, and household resilience.

Method note: Food safety outranks novelty. Preservation, storage, and animal-care guidance stays anchored to official extension and health guidance.

Start a garden that actually feeds you

Design a food garden around calories, climate, season length, and maintenance capacity instead of aesthetics alone.

First action: Estimate sun, water, space, and the vegetables you truly eat before you buy seeds.

Guide answer: To start a garden that actually feeds you, make the first move explicit: Estimate sun, water, space, and the vegetables you truly eat before you buy seeds. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use USDA and state extension services to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: A beautiful plan that exceeds your maintenance capacity is still a bad plan.

Grow food in small spaces

Use containers, vertical space, and crop selection to make limited square footage more productive.

First action: Match the crop to the sun and container depth before buying a dozen random seeds.

Guide answer: To grow food in small spaces, make the first move explicit: Match the crop to the sun and container depth before buying a dozen random seeds. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use USDA and state extension services to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Do not fight the sun map. Crop choice has to respect light, water, and heat reality.

Preserve food by canning

Learn the decision points that make canning safe: acidity, pressure, tested recipes, and disciplined storage.

First action: Start with tested recipes and the right canning method before you buy bulk produce.

Guide answer: To preserve food by canning, make the first move explicit: Start with tested recipes and the right canning method before you buy bulk produce. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use USDA Complete Guide to Home Canning and state extension services to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Food preservation is not a vibes project. Tested recipes and method discipline matter.

Build long-term food storage

Build a food reserve that matches household reality, shelf life, and rotation instead of panic buying.

First action: Calculate what your household actually eats and store that before you chase theoretical survival menus.

Guide answer: To build long-term food storage, make the first move explicit: Calculate what your household actually eats and store that before you chase theoretical survival menus. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use Ready.gov and USDA to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Stored food you never rotate turns into expensive trash.

Raise backyard chickens

Understand the local rules, housing, feeding, health, and routine demands behind backyard egg production.

First action: Check local ordinances, predator pressure, and your daily routine before you buy chicks or build a coop.

Guide answer: To raise backyard chickens, make the first move explicit: Check local ordinances, predator pressure, and your daily routine before you buy chicks or build a coop. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use USDA backyard poultry guidance and state extension services to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Animals create daily obligations. If you cannot sustain the routine, do not romanticize the outcome.

Learn hunting basics legally and safely

Approach hunting as a regulated food and conservation skill with safety, law, ethics, and mentorship at the center.

First action: Complete the hunter education requirements for your state before buying gear or planning a season.

Guide answer: To learn hunting basics legally and safely, make the first move explicit: Complete the hunter education requirements for your state before buying gear or planning a season. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified
floor: Use state wildlife agency and hunter education program to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage
signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This guide is about legal preparation, safety, and field discipline, not weapon tactics.

Fish for food

Learn food fishing as a local, legal, low-complexity skill built around species, access, season, and processing.

First action: Choose one local species and one local water body before buying a pile of gear.

Guide answer: To fish for food, make the first move explicit: Choose one local species and one local water body before buying a pile of gear. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified
floor: Use state wildlife agency and public fisheries guidance to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage
signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Check licenses, contamination advisories, size limits, and cleaning safety before keeping fish.

Bake bread with basic pantry supplies

Use a simple process to turn pantry ingredients into dependable bread without chasing influencer complexity.

First action: Start with one basic loaf formula and make it three times before changing ingredients or methods.

Guide answer: To bake bread with basic pantry supplies, make the first move explicit: Start with one basic loaf formula and make it three times before changing ingredients or methods. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified
floor: Use USDA food guidance and state extension services to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage
signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Consistency comes from repetition and note-taking, not endless recipe switching.

Build compost and soil fertility

Treat compost as a system for soil improvement, waste reduction, and long-term garden productivity.

First action: Start with one manageable pile or bin and learn how moisture, greens, and browns actually balance.

Guide answer: To build compost and soil fertility, make the first move explicit: Start with one manageable pile or bin and learn how moisture, greens, and browns actually balance. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified
floor: Use USDA and state extension services to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage
signal: Progress

means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Compost is a biological process. Wrong inputs and unmanaged moisture create odor and pest problems.

Install solar backup power at home

Design backup power around essential loads, storage limits, weather, and safe installation boundaries.

First action: List the essential loads you truly need during an outage before sizing any hardware.

Guide answer: To install solar backup power at home, make the first move explicit: List the essential loads you truly need during an outage before sizing any hardware. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified

floor: Use Energy.gov and local permitting guidance to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal:

Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This topic crosses electrical, structural, and code boundaries. Many households should plan professionally even if they learn deeply.

PREPAREDNESS

Preparedness, Medical Readiness, and Grid-Down Resilience

Preparedness content wins trust only when it rejects fear-bait and focuses on systems, drills, and recovery.

Demand signal: Mapped to public readiness guidance, emergency planning demand, and repeated household search behavior during disasters.

Method note: Preparedness is a discipline of redundancy and rehearsal, not apocalyptic theater. Medical and safety claims stay conservative.

Build a 72-hour emergency kit

Build a practical household-ready kit by thinking in systems, redundancy, and update cycles instead of random gadgets.

First action: Build one household inventory list before you buy duplicates of things you already own.

Guide answer: To build a 72-hour emergency kit, make the first move explicit: Build one household inventory list before you buy duplicates of things you already own. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use Ready.gov and FEMA to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Preparedness is maintenance. A neglected kit is not readiness.

Purify water in an emergency

Understand what different water treatments can and cannot handle so you do not improvise past the limits.

First action: Learn the difference between clear water, contaminated water, biological risk, and chemical risk before choosing a method.

Guide answer: To purify water in an emergency, make the first move explicit: Learn the difference between clear water, contaminated water, biological risk, and chemical risk before choosing a method. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use CDC water guidance and Ready.gov to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: No single tool solves every contamination problem. Know the limits of filtration, boiling, and chemicals.

Learn basic first aid

Use first aid as a layered household skill rooted in training, scene safety, and clear escalation thresholds.

First action: Book a recognized first-aid class before buying a giant kit you do not know how to use.

Guide answer: To learn basic first aid, make the first move explicit: Book a recognized first-aid class before buying a giant kit you do not know how to use. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use American Red Cross and CDC emergency preparedness guidance to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This guide is educational, not a substitute for certified medical training or emergency care.

Stop bleeding and handle trauma until help arrives

Understand why bleeding control training, kit placement, and scene judgment matter in the first minutes of an emergency.

First action: Take a recognized bleeding-control class and place a basic trauma kit where people actually are.

Guide answer: To stop bleeding and handle trauma until help arrives, make the first move explicit: Take a recognized bleeding-control class and place a basic trauma kit where people actually are. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use Stop the Bleed and American Red Cross to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This guide is not a substitute for certified bleeding-control instruction.

Navigate without GPS

Build basic map, landmark, and route habits so a dead phone or weak signal does not become a bigger emergency.

First action: Carry a paper map for one familiar region and practice planning a route without the phone.

Guide answer: To navigate without GPS, make the first move explicit: Carry a paper map for one familiar region and practice planning a route without the phone. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use Ready.gov and public land navigation guidance to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This is practical navigation literacy, not advanced backcountry survival instruction.

Use ham radio in an emergency

Treat radio as a practice-based communication skill built on licensing, local networks, and repeat drills.

First action: Find the local amateur radio club and licensing path before buying advanced gear.

Guide answer: To use ham radio in an emergency, make the first move explicit: Find the local amateur radio club and licensing path before buying advanced gear. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use FCC amateur radio guidance and ARRL to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Equipment without licensing, practice, and local frequency knowledge is mostly theater.

Heat and cook when the grid is down

Plan for safe heat and cooking options by starting with ventilation, fuel storage, and the real duration of the outage.

First action: List what you already own and identify which options are safe indoors, outdoors, or not safe at all.

Guide answer: To heat and cook when the grid is down, make the first move explicit: List what you already own and identify which options are safe indoors, outdoors, or not safe at all. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use Ready.gov and CDC emergency preparedness guidance to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Combustion, carbon monoxide, and fuel storage mistakes kill people every year.

Stay safe in extreme weather

Use weather safety as a decision-timing skill: know when to prepare, when to shelter, and when to leave.

First action: Define your shelter plan and communication plan before the warning arrives.

Guide answer: To stay safe in extreme weather, make the first move explicit: Define your shelter plan and communication plan before the warning arrives. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use NOAA and Ready.gov to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Preparedness fails when people wait for certainty. Decision timing is the skill.

Strengthen home security and self-protection

Focus on layered security, visibility, routines, and de-escalation rather than fantasies of total control.

First action: Walk the property at night and list the easiest entries, sightline failures, and habit-based vulnerabilities.

Guide answer: To strengthen home security and self-protection, make the first move explicit: Walk the property at night and list the easiest entries, sightline failures, and habit-based vulnerabilities. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use local police prevention guidance and Ready.gov to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This guide emphasizes prevention, environment, and readiness, not violent tactics.

Handle sanitation during an outage

Treat sanitation as a core outage system so a utilities problem does not become a health problem.

First action: Map how your household handles toilet, handwashing, waste, and cleaning if running water fails.

Guide answer: To handle sanitation during an outage, make the first move explicit: Map how your household handles toilet, handwashing, waste, and cleaning if running water fails. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Start With the Principle | Build the Base Setup | Practice the Routine

Proof standard: Proof of readiness: A written plan, a functioning baseline kit, and drill notes prove the system is usable. | Verified floor: Use CDC water guidance and Ready.gov to confirm health, storage, and emergency guidance. | Leverage signal: Progress means the system works under stress without adding drama or maintenance debt.

Action sequence: Define the actual scenario -> Build the smallest working version -> Rehearse the system

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Ignoring sanitation turns short disruptions into illness risk.

CORE SKILLS

Communication, Learning, and Human Core Skills

The highest-leverage skill stack in 2026 still includes writing, explaining, negotiating, and learning quickly.

Demand signal: Informed by employer demand for communication, problem-solving, research, and management-adjacent skills.

Method note: The focus stays on transferable practice systems rather than personality myths or charisma marketing.

Get better at public speaking

Treat speaking as a trainable system built on structure, rehearsal, feedback, and exposure instead of charisma myths.

First action: Record a two-minute explanation of something you know well and study the playback without excuses.

Guide answer: To get better at public speaking, make the first move explicit: Record a two-minute explanation of something you know well and study the playback without excuses. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Clarify the Target | Build a Repeatable Practice | Produce Visible Work

Proof standard: Proof of skill: Visible writing, speaking, teaching, or negotiation artifacts matter more than self-description. | Verified floor: Use OECD AI skill-demand report and public speaking resources as the anchor for what the audience or employer actually values. | Leverage signal: Progress means clearer decisions, better feedback, and stronger opportunities attached to the skill.

Action sequence: Aim the skill at one real use case -> Practice visibly and often -> Use feedback that changes the work

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Confidence is usually a trailing indicator of preparation, not a prerequisite.

Teach yourself math as an adult

Rebuild math by sequencing the foundations correctly and practicing consistently instead of collecting random resources.

First action: Diagnose the last level you truly own rather than starting from the content you wish you already knew.

Guide answer: To teach yourself math as an adult, make the first move explicit: Diagnose the last level you truly own rather than starting from the content you wish you already knew. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Clarify the Target | Build a Repeatable Practice | Produce Visible Work

Proof standard: Proof of skill: Visible writing, speaking, teaching, or negotiation artifacts matter more than self-description. | Verified floor: Use public education resources and community college math support as the anchor for what the audience or employer actually values. | Leverage signal: Progress means clearer decisions, better feedback, and stronger opportunities attached to the skill.

Action sequence: Aim the skill at one real use case -> Practice visibly and often -> Use feedback that changes the work

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Math recovery fails when learners skip the gaps they are embarrassed about.

Learn Spanish for work

Learn job-useful Spanish by focusing on function, listening, repetition, and the words your actual role needs first.

First action: Write the fifty phrases your real work or daily life would most benefit from and learn those first.

Guide answer: To learn Spanish for work, make the first move explicit: Write the fifty phrases your real work or daily life would most benefit from and learn those first. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Clarify the Target | Build a Repeatable Practice | Produce Visible Work

Proof standard: Proof of skill: Visible writing, speaking, teaching, or negotiation artifacts matter more than self-description. | Verified floor: Use public adult education resources and community college language programs as the anchor for what the audience or employer actually values. | Leverage signal: Progress means clearer decisions, better feedback, and stronger opportunities attached to the skill.

Action sequence: Aim the skill at one real use case -> Practice visibly and often -> Use feedback that changes the work

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: If the language never gets used in real context, it will not stick.

Write clearly at work

Write so the reader can understand, decide, and act without decoding your process.

First action: Rewrite one recent message so the decision, action, deadline, and owner are obvious in the first screen.

Guide answer: To write clearly at work, make the first move explicit: Rewrite one recent message so the decision, action, deadline, and owner are obvious in the first screen. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Clarify the Target | Build a Repeatable Practice | Produce Visible Work

Proof standard: Proof of skill: Visible writing, speaking, teaching, or negotiation artifacts matter more than self-description. | Verified floor: Use OECD AI skill-demand report and public writing guidance as the anchor for what the audience or employer actually values. | Leverage signal: Progress means clearer decisions, better feedback, and stronger opportunities attached to the skill.

Action sequence: Aim the skill at one real use case -> Practice visibly and often -> Use feedback that changes the work

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Length is not clarity. Structure is clarity.

Manage projects at work

Use project management as a communication and risk-control skill, not just a software category.

First action: Reduce one current project to scope, owner, sequence, deadline, and top risk on a single page.

Guide answer: To manage projects at work, make the first move explicit: Reduce one current project to scope, owner, sequence, deadline, and top risk on a single page. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Clarify the Target | Build a Repeatable Practice | Produce Visible Work

Proof standard: Proof of skill: Visible writing, speaking, teaching, or negotiation artifacts matter more than self-description. | Verified floor: Use OECD AI skill-demand report and public project management resources as the anchor for what the audience or employer actually values. | Leverage signal: Progress means clearer decisions, better feedback, and stronger opportunities attached to the skill.

Action sequence: Aim the skill at one real use case -> Practice visibly and often -> Use feedback that changes the work

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Tools do not replace scope discipline. Many project problems are actually decision problems.

Lead a team without chaos

Lead by clarifying priorities, removing ambiguity, and setting steady operating rhythms.

First action: Define the top three outcomes, the actual owner of each, and the decision cadence that keeps them moving.

Guide answer: To lead a team without chaos, make the first move explicit: Define the top three outcomes, the actual owner of each, and the decision cadence that keeps them moving. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Clarify the Target | Build a Repeatable Practice | Produce Visible Work

Proof standard: Proof of skill: Visible writing, speaking, teaching, or negotiation artifacts matter more than self-description. | Verified floor: Use OECD AI skill-demand report and public management resources as the anchor for what the audience or employer actually values. | Leverage signal: Progress means clearer decisions, better feedback, and stronger opportunities attached to the skill.

Action sequence: Aim the skill at one real use case -> Practice visibly and often -> Use feedback that changes the work

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Leadership is not vibes. It is clarity, consistency, and accountability under pressure.

Negotiate contracts for freelance and client work

Negotiate contracts by controlling scope, revisions, payment timing, ownership, and change behavior before problems start.

First action: Identify the five terms that matter most before you start debating price.

Guide answer: To negotiate contracts for freelance and client work, make the first move explicit: Identify the five terms that matter most before you start debating price. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Clarify the Target | Build a Repeatable Practice | Produce Visible Work

Proof standard: Proof of skill: Visible writing, speaking, teaching, or negotiation artifacts matter more than self-description. | Verified floor: Use Small Business Administration and state small business legal resources as the anchor for what the audience or employer actually values. | Leverage signal: Progress means clearer decisions, better feedback, and stronger opportunities attached to the skill.

Action sequence: Aim the skill at one real use case -> Practice visibly and often -> Use feedback that changes the work

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: This is educational, not legal advice. Important agreements still deserve jurisdiction-specific review.

Use spreadsheets professionally

Use spreadsheets as systems for truth, not cluttered parking lots for half-finished ideas.

First action: Audit one messy workbook and separate inputs, logic, outputs, and notes into a clearer structure.

Guide answer: To use spreadsheets professionally, make the first move explicit: Audit one messy workbook and separate inputs, logic, outputs, and notes into a clearer structure. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Clarify the Target | Build a Repeatable Practice | Produce Visible Work

Proof standard: Proof of skill: Visible writing, speaking, teaching, or negotiation artifacts matter more than self-description. | Verified floor: Use OECD AI skill-demand report and public spreadsheet training resources as the anchor for what the audience or employer actually values. | Leverage signal: Progress means clearer decisions, better feedback, and stronger opportunities attached to the skill.

Action sequence: Aim the skill at one real use case -> Practice visibly and often -> Use feedback that changes the work

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: A spreadsheet nobody else can audit is a risk, not an asset.

Research anything fast

Research quickly by reducing the question to a claim, checking public records first, and writing notes that preserve what each source can actually prove.

First action: Write the exact claim, evidence threshold, and first public-record system before opening a general search tab.

Guide answer: To research anything fast, make the first move explicit: Write the exact claim, evidence threshold, and first public-record system before opening a general search tab. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Frame the Claim | Build the Source Ladder | Search Public Records

Proof standard: Proof of source discipline: A useful research answer includes the claim sentence, original source links, access dates, document titles, and the confidence label attached to each major fact. | Verified floor: Start with National Archives, Congress.gov, Data.gov, FOIA.gov, FEC data, SEC EDGAR, Federal Register, USAspending, and court records before relying on commentary. | Leverage signal: Progress means another reader can audit the path from question to source to conclusion without reconstructing your search history.

Action sequence: Write the claim brief -> Choose the record system -> Capture audit-ready citations

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Speed without source hierarchy produces confident junk. A screenshot is not a source until the original record is found.

Fact-check information and avoid scams

Use source discipline, fraud pattern recognition, and record-first verification to reduce preventable information and money losses.

First action: Slow the urgent ask, identify the original source, and verify the record or institution before clicking, paying, forwarding, or accusing.

Guide answer: To fact-check information and avoid scams, make the first move explicit: Slow the urgent ask, identify the original source, and verify the record or institution before clicking, paying, forwarding, or accusing. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Slow the Ask | Find the Original Source | Verify the Institution

Proof standard: Proof of verification: A checked claim has an original source, an independent institution path, and a note explaining what the source can and cannot prove. | Verified floor: Use FTC, CFPB, FOIA.gov, official agency pages, court records, company portals, and public filings instead of contact details supplied by the urgent message. | Leverage signal: Progress means fewer rushed decisions, fewer forwarded false claims, and clearer escalation when fraud or public-risk claims appear credible.

Action sequence: Pause the urgent frame -> Find the original source -> Verify through a clean path

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Scams and false claims often win by urgency, isolation, and emotion. Slow down the frame before you answer the ask.

Build an Israel Dossier source file

Turn the Israel dossier into a source ledger where every claim has a source class, access date, confidence label, and publishability note.

First action: Extract one statistic, one incident claim, one aid figure, and one legal claim into a source ledger before writing prose.

Guide answer: To build an Israel Dossier source file, make the first move explicit: Extract one statistic, one incident claim, one aid figure, and one legal claim into a source ledger before writing prose. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Set the Claim Boundary | Build the Source Ladder | Classify the Evidence

Proof standard: Proof of source discipline: A usable dossier artifact includes claim rows, original source links, access dates, source

classes, confidence labels, and explicit open questions. | Verified floor: Use Congressional Research Service, UN OCHA, UNICEF as the first source ladder before relying on commentary, screenshots, reposts, or unsourced summaries. | Leverage signal: Progress means a skeptical editor can trace every number, legal term, and incident claim from prose back to the source row without guessing.

Action sequence: Write the claim row -> Find the original anchor -> Classify the evidence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: A dossier without claim-level source rows will eventually blur reported figures, verified records, estimates, and analysis.

Audit Israel aid records

Separate obligations, appropriations, annual MOU funding, supplemental packages, arms-sale notices, deliveries, and analysis before writing dollar claims.

First action: Create separate rows for the CRS constant-dollar total, annual MOU funding, H.R.815 supplemental appropriations, and DSCA arms-sale notices.

Guide answer: To audit Israel aid records, make the first move explicit: Create separate rows for the CRS constant-dollar total, annual MOU funding, H.R.815 supplemental appropriations, and DSCA arms-sale notices. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Set the Claim Boundary | Build the Source Ladder | Classify the Evidence

Proof standard: Proof of source discipline: A usable dossier artifact includes claim rows, original source links, access dates, source classes, confidence labels, and explicit open questions. | Verified floor: Use Congressional Research Service, Congress.gov, Defense Security Cooperation Agency as the first source ladder before relying on commentary, screenshots, reposts, or unsourced summaries. | Leverage signal: Progress means a skeptical editor can trace every number, legal term, and incident claim from prose back to the source row without guessing.

Action sequence: Write the claim row -> Find the original anchor -> Classify the evidence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Do not add figures from different record types together unless the source and method justify the calculation.

Verify Gaza humanitarian figures

Keep reported figures, UN attribution, institutional verification, survey estimates, and press-freedom trackers visibly separate.

First action: Build an attribution table that names the reporting body, original source, date range, method, and what remains unverified.

Guide answer: To verify Gaza humanitarian figures, make the first move explicit: Build an attribution table that names the reporting body, original source, date range, method, and what remains unverified. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Set the Claim Boundary | Build the Source Ladder | Classify the Evidence

Proof standard: Proof of source discipline: A usable dossier artifact includes claim rows, original source links, access dates, source classes, confidence labels, and explicit open questions. | Verified floor: Use UN OCHA, UNICEF, The Lancet Global Health as the first source ladder before relying on commentary, screenshots, reposts, or unsourced summaries. | Leverage signal: Progress means a skeptical editor can trace every number, legal term, and incident claim from prose back to the source row without guessing.

Action sequence: Write the claim row -> Find the original anchor -> Classify the evidence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Attribution is not a cosmetic footnote. It is the difference between careful publication and unsupported certainty.

Test Israel Dossier incident evidence

Grade incident records by evidence type before deciding whether the wording can say documented, alleged, reported, disputed, or independently verified.

First action: Choose one incident and build a matrix with date, location, alleged actor, evidence type, disputed elements, and minimum defensible wording.

Guide answer: To test Israel Dossier incident evidence, make the first move explicit: Choose one incident and build a matrix with date, location, alleged actor, evidence type, disputed elements, and minimum defensible wording. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Set the Claim Boundary | Build the Source Ladder | Classify the Evidence

Proof standard: Proof of source discipline: A usable dossier artifact includes claim rows, original source links, access dates, source classes, confidence labels, and explicit open questions. | Verified floor: Use Forensic Architecture, OHCHR, World Central Kitchen as the first source ladder before relying on commentary, screenshots, reposts, or unsourced summaries. | Leverage signal: Progress means a skeptical editor can trace every number, legal term, and incident claim from prose back to the source row without guessing.

Action sequence: Write the claim row -> Find the original anchor -> Classify the evidence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Do not let moral urgency override the evidence tier. A serious incident still needs exact attribution and careful verbs.

Read Israel Dossier legal records

Distinguish pleadings, provisional measures, advisory opinions, arrest warrants, merits rulings, and commentary before using legal language.

First action: Create a four-row legal-status brief for ICJ provisional measures, the ICJ occupation advisory opinion, ICC warrants, and unresolved merits questions.

Guide answer: To read Israel Dossier legal records, make the first move explicit: Create a four-row legal-status brief for ICJ provisional measures, the ICJ occupation advisory opinion, ICC warrants, and unresolved merits questions. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Set the Claim Boundary | Build the Source Ladder | Classify the Evidence

Proof standard: Proof of source discipline: A usable dossier artifact includes claim rows, original source links, access dates, source classes, confidence labels, and explicit open questions. | Verified floor: Use International Court of Justice, International Criminal Court, United Nations as the first source ladder before relying on commentary, screenshots, reposts, or unsourced summaries. | Leverage signal: Progress means a skeptical editor can trace every number, legal term, and incident claim from prose back to the source row without guessing.

Action sequence: Write the claim row -> Find the original anchor -> Classify the evidence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: Do not treat allegations, warrants, provisional measures, advisory opinions, and final merits rulings as interchangeable.

Write Israel Dossier briefings

Convert source files into publishable briefings that preserve evidence tiers, access dates, legal boundaries, and unresolved checks.

First action: Draft a 900-word briefing from the aid ledger and humanitarian attribution table while tagging every sentence with a source row.

Guide answer: To write Israel Dossier briefings, make the first move explicit: Draft a 900-word briefing from the aid ledger and humanitarian attribution table while tagging every sentence with a source row. This works best when you treat the path as a system with proof, safety, and documented next steps rather than a viral shortcut.

Course focus: Set the Claim Boundary | Build the Source Ladder | Classify the Evidence

Proof standard: Proof of source discipline: A usable dossier artifact includes claim rows, original source links, access dates, source classes, confidence labels, and explicit open questions. | Verified floor: Use Congressional Research Service, UN OCHA, International Court of Justice as the first source ladder before relying on commentary, screenshots, reposts, or unsourced summaries. | Leverage signal: Progress means a skeptical editor can trace every number, legal term, and incident claim from prose back to the source row without guessing.

Action sequence: Write the claim row -> Find the original anchor -> Classify the evidence

Official anchors: Source floor, Risk boundary

Risk note: A polished briefing that hides uncertainty is not stronger. It is harder to trust.

RESEARCH SOURCES**U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics**

Used to anchor practical trade, maintenance, logistics, and healthcare-support career paths in public labor data.

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/>

Ready.gov preparedness guidance

Used to structure household readiness, kits, outage planning, and emergency communications.

<https://www.ready.gov/>

CDC emergency preparedness guidance

Used for water, hygiene, carbon monoxide, and first-response safety guardrails.

<https://www.cdc.gov/disasters/>

USDA and extension guidance

Used for food safety, preservation, gardening, and basic foraging discipline.

<https://nifa.usda.gov/>

NHTSA vehicle safety guidance

Used for roadside safety, winter travel, battery recovery, and car-maintenance guardrails.

<https://www.nhtsa.gov/road-safety>

Energy.gov home energy guidance

Used for weatherization, backup-power planning, and household resilience systems.

<https://www.energy.gov/energysaver/energy-saver>

National Archives research tools

Used for archival research discipline, record-group discovery, declassified-material paths, and historical source retrieval.

<https://www.archives.gov/research>

Congress.gov API

Used for legislative records, bill metadata, congressional actions, sponsors, committees, and official source paths.

<https://api.congress.gov/>

Federal Register API documentation

Used for agency-rule discovery while preserving the requirement to verify legal precision against official editions.

<https://www.federalregister.gov/developers/documentation/api/v1>

FOIA.gov

Used for request preparation, agency identification, and the rule that public research should come before broad FOIA filing.

<https://www.foia.gov/>

FEC campaign finance data

Used for federal campaign-finance lookup, committee records, receipts, spending, and filing discipline.

<https://www.fec.gov/data/>

SEC EDGAR search filings

Used for company filings, securities disclosures, issuer search, and entity-name verification.

<https://www.sec.gov/search-filings>

USAspending API documentation

Used for federal award, recipient, agency, and spending-data workflows.

<https://api.usaspending.gov/docs/>

Data.gov

Used as a broad federal open-data catalog for research questions that do not begin in a single agency system.

<https://data.gov/>

CourtListener RECAP documentation

Used for court-record research context, RECAP coverage limits, and public PACER-document discovery paths.

<https://www.courtlistener.com/help/coverage/recap/>

National Weather Service safety guidance

Used for severe weather, flood, tornado, winter travel, heat, and alert-response guardrails.

<https://www.weather.gov/safety/>

Poison Help and America's Poison Centers

Used for poison-exposure escalation, plant-ingestion uncertainty, and the national Poison Help pathway.

<https://www.poisonhelp.org/>

American Red Cross first-aid guidance

Used for bleeding-control, first-aid escalation, hypothermia, and household emergency training boundaries.

<https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/resources/learn-first-aid>

NFPA home fire safety guidance

Used for home fire escape, smoke alarms, cooking fires, and household fire-prevention behaviors.

<https://www.nfpa.org/education-and-research/home-fire-safety>

FDA food-safety emergency guidance

Used for power-outage food handling, refrigerator and freezer temperature thresholds, and flood-exposed food decisions.

<https://www.fda.gov/food/food-safety-during-emergencies>

EPA emergency drinking-water guidance

Used for drinking-water disinfection, boiling, filtering, and contaminated-water limits.

<https://www.epa.gov/ground-water-and-drinking-water/emergency-disinfection-drinking-water>